



daily usage. Social media, video calls, web browsing and more work smoothly, but if you're an ardent gamer, the POCO X6 is a better option.

As for software, you've got Realme UI 5.0 based on Android 14. The company provides two years of OS upgrades and three years of security patches, which is lacklustre. And if you've read enough of my Realme reviews, you know how I feel about Realme UI. It is the most bloatware-ridden OS I've experienced in 2023 and now, in 2024 as well. With options like the Nothing Phone (2a) with a clean OS, Realme needs to seriously step up its game in this department.

CAMERA

Housing a 50 MP Sony LYT-600 main camera, the Realme 12+ 5G stands tall as one of the better camera phones in its price segment. The 50 MP sensor has an f/1.8 aperture and OIS capabilities. The other two cameras aren't spectacular though – an 8 MP ultrawide shooter and a 2 MP portrait camera. Either way, it's the primary camera that's the star of the show and it does shine.

There's no missing the solid detail and dynamic range of the photos that come out of the Realme 12+ 5G's primary camera. Shots look great with excellent HDR and vivid colours. The colours are a bit contrast-y but these look great for social media. Close-ups also have solid detail. Even though Realme has boosted the saturation of

scenes, human subjects look closer to natural than they've ever looked on a Realme phone. There is room for improvement still, but they've come a long way.

As for portraits, the Realme 12+ does well with good detail, skin tone, and edge detection. The edge detection is not perfect, but the phone does a commendable job for the asking price.

Ultrawide photos and macro shots could be better; they're just about average. Selfie photos, however, look stellar with good detail retention and dynamic range. There's enough detail present on the faces as well. The phone allows for 4K at 30 fps video recording and 1080p video on the front camera.

BATTERY LIFE

The Realme 12+ 5G has a large 5,000 mAh battery to keep the lights on. The phone supports 67 W SUPERVOOC charging and comes with the charger bundled in the retail box. The battery life, while decent, doesn't break the mold. Sure, the phone can last light users more than a day, but if you click photos, shoot 4K videos, and/or play games; the phone may run dry before the end of the day.

For example, one hour of running Google Maps drained the battery by a whopping 13 percent, and 15 minutes of Call of Duty: Mobile dropped the battery levels by 6 percent. The 67 W charging is pretty fast though. The phone can

charge from zero to full in just 47 minutes, according to our tests.

VERDICT

The Realme 12+ 5G shines in two key areas – design and camera. Priced at ₹20,999, the Realme 12+ 5G stands out due to its well thought out design language; something that most companies shirk off at this price point. Plus, its primary camera shows great promise with good tuning. The Realme 12+ 5G is a no brainer for those who want an eye-turner phone that clicks some great pictures. However, if you're a gamer or someone who wants long-lasting battery life, there are some options in the market that are better. One example is the POCO X6 5G that beats out the Realme 12+ in both these key areas. Also, if you want a cleaner UI, the Nothing Phone (2a) is a good option that costs just ₹3,000 more.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: MediaTek Dimensity 7050 | GPU: ARM Mali-G68 MC4 | RAM: 8 GB LPDDR4X | ROM: 128/256 GB UFS 3.1 | OS: Realme UI 5.0 based on Android 14 | Cameras (rear): 50 MP Sony LYT-600 + 8 MP + 2 MP | Front camera: 16 MP | Display: 6.67-inch FHD+ AMOLED | Display refresh rate: 120 Hz | Display brightness: 1,200 nits peak brightness | Battery capacity: 5,000 mAh | Charging: 67 W SUPERVOOC | Colours: Pioneer Green, Navigator Beige | Weight: 190 g

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